THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 30, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Mistral opens its trillion-parameter model, Cohere raises Canada's largest round, and a tampered extension reaches Cursor users

Mistral AI published the weights of Mistral Large 4, nicknamed Le Chonk, on Thursday, and Dell put it on its Hugging Face hub within hours. Cohere closed the first part of a Series E aimed at up to 7 billion Canadian dollars, with the Canadian government among the backers. Demis Hassabis posted a chart showing Gemini 4 Carbon first on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index, and Elon Musk said Grok 4.8 will not chase benchmarks.

Security dominated the night. Cursor said a modified Claude Code extension in its marketplace reached at most 5,000 users, and Binance put the impact of the largest crypto hack on record at $6.3 billion. Proton's internal push to hand coding to AI drew a defense from David Heinemeier Hansson, and Musk named Neuralink's first two products, Telepathy and Blindsight.

I · OPEN MODELS

Le Chonk's weights go public as Cohere raises Canada's biggest round

Mistral's flagship arrives under a modified MIT license, and Cohere is raising money for sovereign AI with Ottawa as an investor. A small lab's leaner model passed two outside tests.

~1T
Total parameters in Mistral Large 4, with 49 billion active per token

C$35.7B
Cohere's valuation if its Series E reaches its C$7 billion target

43%
Fewer tokens particle-1 used on real-swe at the same performance

Arthur Mensch @arthurmensch · CEO, Mistral AI

"Good progress in the last few weeks ! And now the weights," Mensch wrote at 10:59am EDT Thursday, quoting his company's announcement. Mistral said Le Chonk ranks first among open models on Cognition's FrontierCode test and is state of the art in cyber defense, after testing by CrowdStrike, Cloudflare, Rubrik and Zscaler. The model card describes a mixture-of-experts model with about 1 trillion parameters, 49 billion of them active per token, a context window of 1 million tokens, and text and image input. It was trained on 3,800 Nvidia Grace Blackwell GPUs in Europe.

The weights ship under the Mistral Ecosystem Open-Weight License, a modified MIT license. Anyone may use and modify the model, but a company that sells it as a hosted service needs a separate commercial license. Checkpoints come in FP8 and NVFP4 formats, SiliconANGLE reported. Michael Dell (@MichaelDell), chief executive of Dell Technologies, wrote at 5:59pm EDT that the model is now on the Dell Enterprise Hub on Hugging Face for on-premises use: "On prem, private and secure, unmetered intelligence."

Aidan Gomez @aidangomez · CEO, Cohere

Cohere announced the initial close of its Series E at 11:49am EDT Thursday. The round targets up to C$7 billion at a C$35.7 billion valuation, which the company called the largest private round in Canadian startup history. Schwarz Group, the German retailer, leads. Bell Ventures, Bullhound Capital and the Government of Canada are new investors, and Nvidia, Inovia Capital and Prosperity7 Ventures returned, according to the press release. Ottawa is committing up to C$1.6 billion. The company announced the round at Mila, the Quebec AI institute in Montreal.



Aidan Gomez speaks at the ALL IN conference in Montreal in September 2025.
PHOTO: GABRIEL HUTCHINSON · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Gomez spent the day thanking backers. Jeff Dean (@JeffDean), chief scientist at Google, wrote at 1:46pm EDT: "Congrats, @aidangomez and everyone at @cohere!"

Suhail Doshi @Suhail · Founder, Particle

A day after launching particle-1, Doshi pointed to two outside checks. Particle's account said the model matched its base model, DeepSeek V4.1 Flash, on Parallel's web-research test, 69.2 to 68.9, with 42% fewer output tokens. Doshi called it validation on "something we couldn't train on and is real-world" at 9:41am EDT. Later, the real-swe coding benchmark reported the same performance with 43% fewer tokens, and Doshi wrote at 4:04pm EDT: "Independently validated in real-swe!" His goal, at 11:17am EDT:

> *"We are going to drive cost per task to zero. We will not allow a duopoly to tax humanity on intelligence. We trained on humanity's data, the least we could do is give back and let everyone prosper."*
> SUHAIL DOSHI · @SUHAIL · 11:17AM EDT · POST

II · FRONTIER RACE

Carbon tops the index, and Musk says Grok 4.8 won't chase benchmarks

Hassabis posted the leaderboard, Musk asked when the public can use Carbon, and a voice-agent platform from Cartesia took first place on two independent tests.

59	**1115**	**$0.61**
Gemini 4 Carbon's score on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index v5.0	Cartesia Managed Agents' Elo on the Speech Agent Arena, ranked first	Cost per task of Samaya's Sterling, against $6.89 for Claude Fable 5.1

Demis Hassabis @demishassabis · Co-founder and chair, Google DeepMind

"No.1," Hassabis wrote at 6:25pm EDT Thursday, posting the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index v5.0 chart. Gemini 4 Carbon leads at 59, ahead of Claude Opus 5.5 at 58 and GPT-6 Astra at 57. Grok 4.7 sits at 34. Carbon is currently limited to trusted cyber defenders. Musk replied at 7:00pm EDT: "Well done! When can it be accessed?"

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, Tesla and SpaceX

Answering a user who wrote that apart from voice, SpaceXSI "barely has any SOTA models," meaning state-of-the-art, Musk wrote:

> *"I know it's taken longer than expected, but Grok 4.8 will not be a disappointment. We're not optimizing for benchmarks and I really don't care how Grok does on those, but it will be incredibly useful."*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 1:17AM EDT · POST

He also promoted Grok Bot, the company's agent product. Quoting a post that cited Similarweb data showing daily users rising from under 100,000 in early September to more than 600,000 by Oct. 26, he wrote at 5:39pm EDT: "Worth noting that Grok @Bot has no free tier." Overnight he added "Hire Grok @Bot to be an employee" and, quoting a user who had it build a concert playlist in 30 seconds, "It's great @Bot."

> QUICK HIT
> **Yann LeCun** (@ylecun), Turing Award winner and longtime advocate of energy-based models, replied at 7:04pm EDT to Alexi Glad's introduction of TEM, Transformer Energy-based Models, which Glad says outscale diffusion models: "EBM FTW"

Albert Gu @_albertgu · Co-founder, Cartesia

"We build not just models but the whole stack - #1 on Speech Agent Arena!" Gu wrote at 5:33pm EDT. Cartesia's Managed Agents platform for enterprise phone agents scored an Elo of 1115 in Artificial Analysis's blind human comparisons, ahead of Google's Gemini 3.1 Flash Live at 1099. On ServiceNow's EVA-Bench it posted 87.4% for accuracy and 90.7% for experience; xAI's Grok Voice 3.0 was next on accuracy at 73.7%. Cartesia noted that its tests used GPT-5.5 as the reasoning model.

Jeff Dean @JeffDean · Chief scientist, Google

Dean called Samaya AI's new model "gold" at 2:29pm EDT. Samaya co-founder Maithra Raghu said Sterling, post-trained from Nvidia's Nemotron 3.5 Lightning, a 30-billion-parameter mixture-of-experts model with 3 billion active, scored 58.9%

on FrontierFinance against 55.9% for Claude Fable 5.1, at $0.61 a task against $6.89.

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang · Chief AI officer, Meta

Wang promoted the brevity of Meta's Muse assistant. "muse is built different!! muse team is anti-slop-text," he wrote at 9:26am EDT. He also shared a clip claiming ChatGPT writes 6.7 times as much as Muse to answer the same question.

On Thursday at 3:10pm EDT Wang wrote "hell yeah" to engineer Seth Rose, who had put Muse to work logging possible Telephone Consumer Protection Act violations in a Google Sheet; each violation can cost the sender $500 to $1,500.

Fei-Fei Li @drfeifei · Co-founder and CEO, World Labs

Li cheered at 2:23pm EDT Thursday as the Spark project shared an experimental release of Spark Radix, a WebGPU renderer built on the three.js library that draws detailed 3D worlds made of Gaussian splats, millions of soft overlapping points, directly in a web browser. Developers can try it now.

Joe Gebbia @jgebbia · Co-founder, Airbnb

"The future has arrived," Gebbia wrote at 10:21am EDT Thursday, quoting Simulon founder Divesh Naidoo's post on the launch of Reality-Aware Rendering. A user places neural assets with a phone and acts out the scene; when recording stops, Simulon renders the take, reading everything in it, including what the user does and says.

Greg Brockman @gdb · President, OpenAI

Brockman welcomed Jeff Crowell, who wrote that he joined OpenAI this week after 10 years at Apple "to work on the frontier of cybersecurity research."

III · SECURITY

A tampered Claude Code build reaches Cursor users, and Binance loses billions

Cursor shut down and rebuilt its extension marketplace. Binance says it will cover all losses, and Anthropic described how Claude now grades its own conversations for misuse.

5,000	$6.3B	94%
Maximum number of Cursor users the malicious extension reached	Binance's estimate of the impact of Thursday's security incident	High-priority misuse cases Claude's self-assessment flags at a 1% false-positive rate

Michael Truell @mntruell · CEO, Cursor

Cursor's security notice said a modified version of Anthropic's Claude Code extension, version 2.1.313, was available in Cursor's marketplace from about 5:27am to 4:35pm EDT Thursday. The extension was not built by Anthropic. It tried to add an attacker's SSH key, labeled "svc-telemetry," open a reverse SSH tunnel, install persistence and report host details. Cursor said the tunnel step fails on most machines because it needs administrator rights, and that the attacker's server has been taken offline. The company said it took the marketplace down, confirmed no other extensions were touched, and reinstated it. It asked users to update to version 2.1.314, and noted the incident did not affect Grok Bot, Grok or other SpaceXSI products. Cursor rotated its own keys and rebuilt the marketplace before bringing it back.

Replying to a user who had shared a blog post about a compromised extension, Truell wrote at 3:50am EDT Friday: "We've spoken with the author of this blog and do not believe the official Claude Code VS Code extension was compromised. We believe this is instead a report of this incident." Uninstalling the extension may not remove the backdoor, Cursor warned, and affected users should rotate credentials.

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, Tesla and SpaceX

Binance estimated the impact of Thursday's breach at $6.3 billion, with about $3 billion frozen on-chain. It said a compromised DevOps engineer's laptop may have let an attacker submit unauthorized withdrawals, and pledged to cover all losses. Tether and Circle froze more than $2.3 billion in stablecoins. Quoting early reports at 6:33pm EDT, Musk wrote "Everyday is Zeroday." When a crypto commentator noted that the hacker was borrowing ether against stolen funds on the lending protocol Aave, Musk replied at 11:12pm EDT: "Super intelligence agents will at some point do this to gain currency for themselves, not a human."

Musk also answered Anthropic's post on self-assessment, a technique in which Claude reviews each conversation for misuse right after it responds, with "Good idea." On Claude Fable 5 it flags 78% of conversations that a stronger classifier marks as potentially harmful, and 94% of high-priority ones. Anthropic says it adds less than 2% to inference compute and is not robust against a determined attacker.

ON THE WIRE

Update now. Cursor asked users to move to version 2.1.314 of the Claude Code extension, per its security notice.

Proton's AI memo splits builders as Levie says the frontier is pulling away

Heinemeier Hansson called the memo routine business. Carmack asked what a standard library built for agents would look like, and Vercel now takes bug reports from agents.

90%	3–6 mo.	2 yrs
Share of Proton's October code written by AI, its CTO said in a meeting	How quickly codified AI processes fall behind, in Levie's view	Of component price pain Sweeney expects before chip abundance

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

At 12:50am EDT Friday, Levie wrote that the distance between people working at the AI frontier and everyone else is "almost incomprehensible" and growing. "The curve of AI progress is basically going vertical right now, which means if you had codified your processes 3-6 months ago you're likely already behind again," he wrote, adding that "AI native companies certainly have a strong advantage." Musk quoted it with one word: "True."

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · Creator, Ruby on Rails

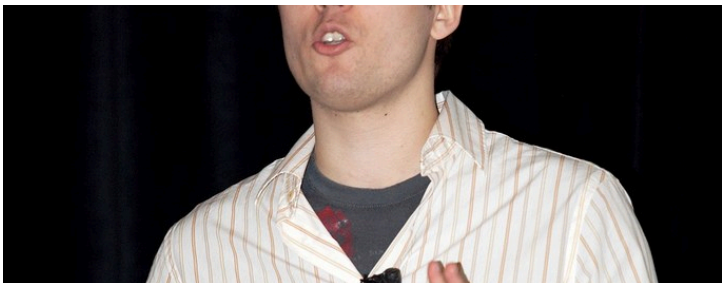
404 Media reported that Proton, the Swiss maker of encrypted email, is pushing staff hard toward AI. Chief technology officer Bart Butler wrote in an internal manifesto that "your old job is gone" and that most code should be reviewed by AI, not humans. Chief executive Andy Yen wrote in Slack that this will be the last year Proton hires engineers, and the company plans to re-interview staff about their AI use. Heinemeier Hansson responded at 6:02am EDT Friday: "There is nothing scandalous in this memo." Four minutes later he went further:

> *"The real AI psychosis is thinking "this is just another tool" or "it's just a stochastic parrot" and "humans still need to review every line". You gotta snap out of it."*
>
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · 6:06AM EDT · POST

Asked whether juniors lose out, he said "juniors who lean into usually become more valuable than seniors who don't." When a reader said he still reviews every line "mostly so I feel useful," Heinemeier Hansson answered: "You're not being all that useful if the volume of work you're having agents produce is still manageable to review by hand." At 7:03am EDT he added that "journalists have a tendency to make things sound differently from how they actually are." For a company "refusing to adapt to reality," he wrote, he has "complete sympathy for some shock therapy. Because the alternative is that the business becomes uncompetitive, customers eventually leave, and everyone is fired."

ON THE WIRE

Agent feedback. Vercel's MCP server now lets agents send feedback to Vercel directly.



David Heinemeier Hansson speaks at the O'Reilly Emerging Technology Conference in 2006.

PHOTO: JAMES DUNCAN DAVIDSON/O'REILLY MEDIA · CC BY 2.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · Creator, Omarchy

At 10:55am EDT Thursday Heinemeier Hansson showed Omarchy, his Linux setup, running natively on the Asus Zenbook A16 with Qualcomm's Snapdragon X2 Extreme chip, calling it "very enticing" at $1,899 with 48GB of memory, 512GB of storage, a 3K OLED screen and a 1.2kg chassis. Webcam and Bluetooth do not work yet: the drivers needed are being extracted from the Windows install and are under license, and he asked Qualcomm and Asus for help bundling them. Later he pointed to ArtCraft's WordCraft and GridCraft, a word processor and spreadsheet rebuilt in Rust: "Word and Excel reimagined for Linux with full compatibility! Maybe we don't need that Microsoft port of Office after all?"

John Carmack @ID_AA_Carmack · Founder, Keen Technologies

> *"AI may well be able to write massive software projects "from scratch", but that almost certainly isn't the fastest / highest performance / highest security / most token efficient way to do things. Good building blocks matter. In addition to RL'ing the agents on final task loss, we should try to get them to regularize the building blocks as well. What would the standard library look like that makes the agents most effective? It is likely at the limit that it turns out to be some alien organization of code, but given the existing human-bias in training, I bet that in the near term it would be lovely code that old programmers would appreciate. I suspect the same could be said for mathematics, but that is out of my lane."*
>
> JOHN CARMACK · @ID_AA_CARMACK · 5:24PM EDT · POST

RL refers to reinforcement learning, training a model on rewards for finished tasks.

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

Vercel's MCP server, the Model Context Protocol interface agents use to work with its platform, now lets agents send feedback to Vercel directly. "The future of software engineering is agents talking to other agents. Even across different companies," Rauch wrote at 2:31pm EDT, suggesting developers tell their agents to send Vercel feedback. Later he welcomed the new Node.js long-term-support release on Vercel, noting that fetch now uses HTTP/2 by default, "and agents produce a lot of network traffic."

Tobi Lütke @tobi · CEO, Shopify

Lütke said at 8:35pm EDT Thursday that he "really enjoyed" his interview with Alex Heath in Toronto on where agent commerce is headed. Heath's preview asks why Amazon blocked Meta's Muse while Shopify welcomed it.

QUICK HIT

Paul Graham (@paulg), co-founder of Y Combinator, at 9:23pm EDT Thursday: "Funding rounds aren't milestones. It shouldn't be your goal to raise a series A. It should be your goal not to need to."

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · CEO, Epic Games

Quoting a tutorial on making Unreal Engine games with AI, Sweeney wrote at 6:50am EDT Friday: "The next 12 months of gaming and game development will be insanely cool and empowering!" Engines will survive because using one has been "more productive and economical" than building your own, he said, and Epic is updating its file management to "support text and binary file formats for everything, losslessly convertible." On hardware costs: "There's probably 2 years of component price pain ahead followed by a period of memory and computing abundance as massive new fabs ramp up production. Semiconductor experts "know" fabs take 4 years to build, but neither XAI nor China know that!"

Asked whether games will pair AI-generated photorealistic visuals with a simple 3D engine underneath, Sweeney replied at 7:12am EDT that two extremes already exist, from Decart's real-time repainting of simple Blender scenes to big-budget games modestly enhanced with Nvidia's DLSS. He expects the boundary between rendering and AI synthesis to land "somewhere in the middle."

V · BRAINS, CARS AND CHIPS

Musk names Neuralink's first two products, and Robotaxi runs until 2am

Telepathy is for thought-driven communication and Blindsight is meant to restore sight. Tesla's ride service added hours and Grok, and Italy backed a quick EU approval of its driver assistance.

72 hrs
Length of Neuralink's hackathon with a speech-study participant

6am–2am
New operating hours for Tesla's Robotaxi service

2100
The year Musk hopes von Neumann probes are exploring the galaxy

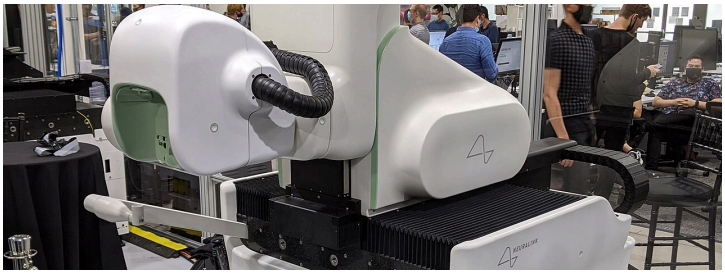
Elon Musk @elonmusk · Co-founder, Neuralink

Neuralink said its engineers spent 72 hours with a participant in its speech restoration study, prototyping features for communicating by thought. Its write-up describes automatic detection of when the user is trying to speak, so no button is needed. Quoting the thread just after midnight, Musk wrote:

> *"Neuralink's first product is called Telepathy. It enables high-speed communication with computers or humans simply by thinking. Output bandwidth will vastly exceed the fastest human speech or typing in a few years. Read that sentence again."*
>
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 12:06AM EDT · POST

Four minutes later: "Our second product is called Blindsight and it will, as the name suggests, enable even those who are completely blind or have never seen to see. It is ready from an engineering standpoint. Just waiting on regulatory approval."

Blindsight received the Food and Drug Administration's Breakthrough Device Designation in September 2024, which speeds review but is not approval; Neuralink's implants remain investigational devices. At 12:36am EDT Musk added that in a few years Neuralink hopes to "shunt signals from the motor and sensory areas of the brain to the limbs and enable people to use their hands and walk again."



Neuralink's implant-surgery robot on display at the company's August 2020 event.

PHOTO: LEIJURV · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Ashok Elluswamy @aelluswamy · Head of Autopilot and AI software, Tesla

Tesla's Robotaxi service extended its hours to 6am to 2am, added a rear camera feed riders can watch, trip sharing, a Calm Mode that dims the screen and cabin lighting, and Grok in its Model Y vehicles. Elluswamy's comment at 1:48am EDT Friday: "Until bar closing time now!"

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, Tesla

Italy's transport minister, Matteo Salvini, said after a call with Musk that Italy supports a swift EU-wide approval of Tesla Assisted Driving, Europe's name for Full Self-Driving (Supervised), LaPresse reported. The system stays at Level 2, with the driver responsible. Musk replied at 9:02am EDT Thursday: "Much appreciated. Thank you!"



A Tesla Model Y charges on Odeonsplatz in Munich, Germany, on September 4, 2023.

PHOTO: AUHAIDHAUSEN / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 4.0

On chips, he quoted a post citing Korea's The Elec, in which a Korean supplier executive said questions sent to the Terafab team during early US morning hours get answers within 30 minutes to an hour, and wrote at 1:12am EDT Friday: "The Terafab project is going well." And quoting a clip in which Mustafa Suleyman, chief executive of Microsoft AI, recalled Larry Page saying he would explore the galaxies "at the head of a von Neumann probe," a self-replicating spacecraft, Musk wrote at 11:19am EDT Thursday: "Our civilization would be winning wondrously if we are exploring the galaxy with Von Neumann probes by 2100! Larry Page might be right. He has correctly predicted many things."

QUICK HIT

Palmer Luckey (@PalmerLuckey), founder of Anduril, at 2:11pm EDT Thursday, answering a critic who said US electronics manufacturing is not viable: "It is viable. I am doing it. ModRetro is about to launch several Made in USA products. Even Oculus had one!"

BY THE NUMBERS

1115	Elo for Cartesia's Managed Agents on Artificial Analysis's blind comparisons, per Cartesia
$6.3B	Binance's estimate of the breach's impact, per CNBC
$1,899	Price of the Asus Zenbook A16 running Omarchy, per David Heinemeier Hansson

Takeaways

1. Mistral's trillion-parameter Le Chonk is open to download, but hosting it as a service needs a separate license.
2. Sovereign AI is drawing state money: Ottawa is putting up to C$1.6 billion into Cohere.
3. Gemini 4 Carbon leads the main intelligence index, while Musk says Grok 4.8 will aim for usefulness over benchmarks.
4. The Cursor incident shows AI coding tools' extension stores are now a target for attackers.
5. Builders are split on Proton's push to drop human code review.
6. Neuralink's Blindsight is ready from an engineering standpoint, Musk says, and now waits on regulators.

On the beat

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Elon Musk, David Heinemeier Hansson, Suhail Doshi, Tim Sweeney, Michael Dell, Albert Gu, Aidan Gomez, Guillermo Rauch, Palmer Luckey, Paul Graham, Tobi Lütke, Jeff Dean, Alexandr Wang, Joe Gebbia, Uncle Bob Martin, Michael Truell, Greg Brockman, Ashok Elluswamy, Yann LeCun, Demis Hassabis, John Carmack, Fei-Fei Li, Andrej Karpathy, Aaron Levie, Arthur Mensch.

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Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Sam Altman, Dario Amodei, Patrick Collison, Satya Nadella, Vitalik Buterin, François Chollet, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Tom Brown, Clément Delangue, Jim Fan, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, Noam Brown, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Sundar Pichai, Kanjun Qiu, Nat Friedman, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen, Kevin Weil.

The list stands at 50.

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